

Motorola Edge 50 Fusion

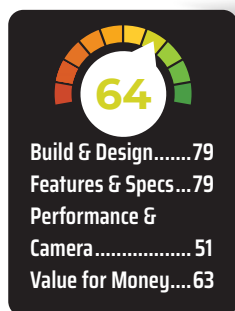
The style champion under ₹25,000

Motorola has been on a roll in 2024, consistently delivering stellar products one after another. One notable launch this year was the Motorola Edge 50 Pro, which I described in my review as "a nearly perfect mid-range phone." Now, just two months later, Motorola has introduced a more affordable version of the Edge 50 Pro, dubbed the Motorola Edge 50 Fusion. To keep costs down, the Edge 50 Fusion makes some compromises, such as using cheaper materials, incorporating a less powerful processor, and forgoing the telephoto lens. However, priced at ₹22,999, it still offers enough features to be intriguing—at least on paper. With competitors such as the OnePlus Nord CE4, Realme Narzo 70 Pro, and Nothing Phone (2a), there's little room for error though. So, let's see how the Motorola Edge 50 Fusion stacks up against these phones in my detailed review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

Set the Motorola Edge 50 Pro and Edge 50 Fusion side-by-side; many will find it difficult to tell the siblings apart. The curved edges, elegant contours, and seamless camera module design is nearly identical. The design screams luxury; it is commendable that Motorola has brought this level of opulence at the sub-₹25,000 price point. However, there are a few subtle differences between the 50 Pro and 50 Fusion when it comes to the build.

Firstly, the Edge 50 Fusion is slightly slimmer and lighter, at 7.9 mm and 175 g respectively. However, given the lower price point, Motorola has opted for a plastic frame in contrast to the more premium aluminium frame on the Motorola Edge 50 Pro. Both come equipped with an IP68 rating though, making this phone one



of the only devices under ₹25K with flagship-level dust and water resistance. Once again, the Pantone collaboration delivers some gorgeous colour options including Forest Blue (matte finish), Hot Pink (vegan suede), and Marshmallow Blue (vegan leather). I got the Marshmallow Blue variant for review and immediately fell in love with the attractive pastel hue. The box houses a translucent plastic case; sadly it's not colour-matched like the one found in the Motorola Edge 50 Pro's box but you can see the rear panel's colour through the translucent material, so, it's all good.

Given that it is lighter and slimmer than the Edge 50 Pro, the in-hand feel is even better—which is excellent since the Edge 50 Pro was already one of the most ergonomic phones. The back panel of the Motorola Edge 50 Fusion is nice and grippy but the in-display optical fingerprint sensor is on the slower side. The haptics are good and the buttons have optimal

tactility too. This is, without a doubt, one of the best-designed phones you can get your hands on under ₹25,000; and it is my personal favourite.

DISPLAY

Motorola's display choices involve some compromises that may disappoint users, especially given that competing phones have fewer trade-offs. For example, while Motorola opts for a higher refresh rate of 144 Hz, it does not support HDR. Additionally, the 144 Hz refresh rate does not activate in Auto/Adaptive mode, meaning that if you select it in the settings, your battery life will suffer significantly.

Personally, I would prefer a 120 Hz display with HDR10+ support, like those offered by competing phones such as the OnePlus Nord CE4, Realme Narzo 70 Pro, and Nothing Phone (2a). Although the phone supports Widevine L1, allowing HD content streaming on OTT platforms, the absence of HDR is a notable drawback in this price range. Given the fact that so many of us consume content on our smartphones today, HDR support is increasingly important for an ideal viewing experience.

Additionally, the colour accuracy is also off. Colours appear far too vivid and contrasty, making things look unnatural. While some may prefer this look, it is far from accurate.

Let me get the rest of the display specifications out of the way. The Motorola Edge 50 Fusion has a 6.7-inch pOLED display with Full HD+ resolution and 144 Hz refresh rate. It is a 10-bit display with a peak brightness of 1,600 nits on HBM (High Brightness Mode). I've already highlighted my gripes, so let me talk about a few of the positives. The display is quite bright and it has excellent viewing angles. Blacks look inky deep on the OLED panel as well. In my tests, the Motorola Edge 50 Fusion's display got a reading of 1,206 nits of brightness under bright sunlight on HBM, which is excellent. All in all, the display is a mixed bag—the lack of HDR is irksome, but the brightness levels and viewing angles are great for the price.

PERFORMANCE AND UI

The Motorola Edge 50 Fusion is not for